

70 Research and Practice for Persons with Severe Disabilities 41(1) We are aware that if Judith had not done so, someone else would likely have conceptualized something like Circles. It is, in fact, an ancient concept. However, it was time to begin reviving mutuality and interdependence in our societies, and it was Judith who was the spark, the catalyst, and thus, the connector for so many of us. Asking the Great Questions Judith once said, "A great question refuses to be answered; so it keeps leading us into deeper connections with each other and into deeper thinking." As Judith's life depended on the asking of great questions, she became a master of questioning. In so doing, she made it possible for others to pursue great questions, taking them to places they did not even know existed. As a philosopher, as a scientist, as a researcher, as an engineer, as a guru, and ultimately as an artist, Judith learned and in turn taught us to pursue the question of "How do I make the invisible, visible?" The implicit and explicit questions she stewarded led engineers to discover how a woman with only movement in one thumb could control a 300 lb motorized wheelchair; and when her thumb no longer worked, how her breath could; how burly bouncers in upstairs nightclubs could make a building accessible; how adventurers could make canoeing and rock climbing possible; and how artists, engineers, and programmers could make it possible for her to paint and sculpt. But mostly, Judith's mastery of the great question magnetically drew people to join in the quest; all were welcomed and ultimately the community that emerged would seek a bigger question, calling us all to go deeper. Asset-Based Community Development and More Although Judith was deeply engaged in issues around disability, her interests and commitments were so much broader. Judith fulfilled a dream that she had for many years: to be rooted in her local community, with all the diversity, joys, challenges, and problems that are integral to all communities. As a neighbor and active leader in community development projects with her friends and neighbors, and in the local community health center (LAMP) as an executive member of the Board, Judith was a great neighbor and a respected agent for change by those who knew her in the Lakeshore community. Judith was a founding member of the Marsha Forest Centre, and while the Center supported Judith, she supported families and the development of Circles with the Center for 25 years. She joined the faculty of the ABCD Institute with John McKnight, and was a key thinker and provocateur with that remarkable team of 52. She took community development into politics and challenged the nature of our democracy by being a member of the communist party, running as a candidate in three Canadian elections. She was a live exhibit at the Royal Ontario Museum for an extended showing of 9 months. It was an art exhibit, with Judith as a living part of the exhibit, shocking unsuspecting patrons and staff into a deeper understanding of possibility. She was key to a team of gamers who are still working on a computerized "Zombie" game where, to survive, you must help the Zombies to be included: a game of inclusion, now that is a Judith twist. Respectful Interdependence The first time one met Judith they might have been struck with the thought that she was the epitome of independent living. Those of us who were fortunate enough to come to know Judith more intimately quickly learned that her life was lived in respectful interdependence. Judith depended on friends and allies to help her carry her message, which became our message. Early on, Judith showed people what an independent minded woman who used a wheelchair could do. Later on in her career and life, Judith showed us what respectful interdependence could look like in so many different ways. As Judith spoke about the idea of gifts and giftedness, she was calling forward the idea of interdependence rather than independence.